

NICHOLAS MARTENS

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan

A.B. in Economics + Philosophy, Politics, and Economics — Highest Honors in Economics

Ann Arbor, MI

2020-2024

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago – Becker Friedman Institute for Economics

Research Professional for Dr. Evan Rose [40 hours per week]

Chicago, IL

Jul 2024-Present

- Developed workflow for processing EEOC administrative data files and federal court documents into integrated, replicable datasets and evaluating potential sources of exogenous variation in the EEOC investigative process
- Leveraged machine learning techniques (XGBoost) to construct novel dataset of geocoded labor demand shocks, model incidence of labor demand shocks, and match shocked neighborhoods to appropriate controls
- Unearthed a novel finding from Survey of Consumer Expectations, then updated Burdett-Mortensen search model to accommodate it

University of Michigan – Department of Economics

Research Assistant for Dr. Dean Yang [8 hours per week]

Ann Arbor, MI

Jan 2023-Apr 2024

- Automated geospatial data processing and visualization, reducing runtime and improving replicability of the analysis at the heart of NBER Working Paper 33482

University of Michigan – Population Studies Center

Research Associate for Dr. William Frey [4 hours per week]

Ann Arbor, MI

Sep 2020-Jun 2024

- Managed all analytical work for NICHD-funded project, developing training materials on SAS and allocating work to six student-employees

University of Michigan – Department of Political Science

Research Assistant for Dr. Edie Goldenberg [6 hours per week]

Ann Arbor, MI

Apr 2022-Aug 2024

- Created four presentations on public policy, presenting complex topics such as redistricting and state ballot initiatives while remaining digestible to more than 1,000 students

University of Michigan – Department of Sociology

Research Assistant for Dr. Robert Manduca [3 hours per week]

Ann Arbor, MI

Oct 2022-Apr 2023

- Automated collection of BEA regional accounts and demographic data for all US counties with R script, reducing manual downloads and improving replicability

Brookings Institution – Workforce of the Future Initiative

Research Intern [40 hours per week]

Washington, DC

Jun 2022-Aug 2022

- Conducted preliminary validation of resume data, assessing quality of variables and developing documentation eventually used for honors thesis

W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research – Place-Based Research Initiative

Research Intern [15 hours per week]

Kalamazoo, MI

Jun 2021-May 2022

- Developed R script to generate synthetic microdata, reweighting PUMA-level microdata based on tract-level benchmarks to model demographic interactions too complex for summary data

WORKING PAPERS

Martens, Nicholas. "Plugging the [Brain] Drain: Evidence from LinkedIn Profiles." Revision in progress.

PUBLICATIONS

Bolter, Kathleen and **Nicholas Martens.** "Can Anyone Learn to Code? A Qualitative Study of Promising Practices for Information Technology Training Programs." *Economic Development Quarterly*. 39 no. 1 (August 28, 2024): 37-48.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2024** University of Michigan, Population Association of America Annual Meeting [flash session], University of Chicago
2025 Population Association of America Annual Meeting [poster session], University of Chicago

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

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|-------------|---------------------------------------|---|---------|
| 2025 | NextGenPop Travel Award | Supplemental award to cover travel costs of former NextGenPop Fellows presenting at 2025 Population Association of America Annual Meeting | \$500 |
| 2024 | Highest Honors in Economics | Awarded by the Department of Economics at the University of Michigan based on quality of honors thesis | |
| 2024 | Harold Osterweil Memorial Prize | Six senior economics majors at the University of Michigan with the most outstanding academic record and the greatest social awareness. | \$1,000 |
| 2024 | John E. Parker Memorial Prize | Most outstanding undergraduate writing on labor economics or human resources. | \$1,000 |
| 2024 | Sweetland Undergraduate Writing Prize | Top two upper-level social science papers written by University of Michigan undergraduates in 2023-24 academic year | \$300 |
| 2023 | NextGenPop Fellow | Year-long population research pipeline program for 20 fellows from under-represented groups, including two-week intensive camp at Cornell University and attending the 2024 Population Association of America Annual Meeting. | \$2,515 |
| 2023 | James B. Angell Scholar | University of Michigan undergraduates who only receive As for two consecutive semesters | |